

=ROUND(A1,4) will give the result 2564897.5689

=ROUND(A1,-4) will give the result 2560000

Normally By default, Excel will round up the result if your the last number of after the specified decimal places is greater than or equal to 5. For example, 1.5, when rounded to zero decimal places, will always round up the value to show as 2, while 1.4 will be rounded down to show as 1. If you want Excel to always round up (or round down) the result, you can use the ROUNDDUP (and ROUNDDOWN) functions. In this case when ROUNDDUP is applied any decimal will round up to the next higher number or when ROUNDDOWN is applied the decimal will round down to the lower number. Example:

=ROUNDDUP(1.43237,2) will give the result 1.44

=ROUNDDOWN(2.5678,2) will give the result 2.56

Note that the default rounding by Excel would have given the first result as 1.43 and the second result as 2.57.

CEILING(number,significance)

When you want to round up to a specific unit then the CEILING function is the one to use. This can be best explained by means of an example. Assume you have a Excel shopping list of many items with the varying prices especially in the decimal portion—that is, you have one item for Rs. 102.35, another for Rs. 74.85 and so on. Now assume that for reasons of tidiness or totalling ease you either want it all to be either rounded to the nearest 50 paise or rupee. The CEILING function will do it for you.

=CEILING(102.35,0.5) will give the result 102.50

=CEILING(74.85,0.5) will give the result 75.00

In the above example, by setting the significance argument to 0.5 we tell Excel to round off the number to the nearest point fifth of a unit. Thus, if the significance is changed to 1 then the results will be 103 and 75 respectively.